



THE NEW ONE MINUTE MANAGER

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The Big “So What”



In this updated version of the bestselling book, *The One Minute Manager*, the authors share **3 important secrets that will help you to concurrently get better results, have more time, and empower the people around you to be more effective and fulfilled.** Apply these powerful tips to both your work and personal life, to enjoy a happier and more fulfilling life.

Introduction



This book retains the core ideas from the original bestseller, *The One Minute Manager*, with updates to reflect the changes in attitudes and priorities at the workplace over the last 35 years. In particular, **the pace of change has increased rapidly.** People are also no longer content to just trade time for money in a job, and to find fulfilment during off-work hours. Instead, **people seek satisfying jobs where they can make meaningful contributions, feel engaged and appreciated.**

Similar to the original book, the authors use a fable to illustrate the key ideas. The story is about a smart young man, who has been looking all over the world for a great manager to work for and learn from. He finds that most companies are either results-driven (focusing on profits and targets at their people's expense), or people-driven (taking care of their people to the point that organizational objectives are not met). He finally finds a great manager - who is known as **the “New One Minute Manager”, or “New OMM” for short in this summary.** The New OMM

- **Has found the secret formula to concurrently achieve results for the company, and fulfilment for his team; and**
- **Is able to adapt his techniques to keep up with rapid changes.**

KEY QUOTES

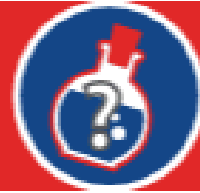
“We trust you'll consider using the Three Secrets you'll discover...you and the people you work and live with will enjoy healthier, happier, and more productive lives.”

“In these changing times... the most effective managers manage themselves and the people they work with so that both the people and the organization profit from their presence.”

“Just as the world has changed, so has the One Minute Manager. He has a new, more collaborative approach to leading and motivating people.”

By interviewing the New OMM and his managers, the young man discovers the 3 Secrets of the New OMM, is eventually offered a job, and becomes a New OMM himself. In this summary, we'll present the key components of the 3 Secrets.

The Three Secrets of the New One-Minute Manager®



Let's zoom in on the 3 secrets of the New OMM.

Secret #1: "One Minute Goals"



One common problem in organizations is the lack of clearly defined roles and responsibilities. **In order for people to be effective:**

- They must know exactly what their goals are and what success looks like; and
- This definition must be shared between the staff and supervisor.

To use One-Minute Goals effectively:



Develop the goals with your staff. Listen to them, show them what it means to perform well, and discuss the goals together. Do not set goals for people.



One-minute goals. Zoom in on the 3-5 most vital goals and have your staff write them out – including what needs to be done and by when – on 1 page.

- o Focus on the 20% that will deliver 80% of the results.
- o The goals and performance standards must be presented succinctly (in, say, 1-2 paragraphs) and can be read in 1 minute or less.
- o Share the goals so everyone is aligned.
- o Goals for special projects, if any, should be documented with separate one-page goals.

KEY QUOTES

"To succeed sooner, managers must be both results-oriented and people-oriented."

"Many managers assume wrongly that the people on their team know what to aim for."

"(The) Manager makes sure we know what good performance looks like because he shows us. In other words, expectations are clear to both of us."

This paves the way for you to apply the other 2 secrets of the New OMM: to praise people when they do something right, and *re-direct* them when they are off-track.

Secret #2: "One Minute Praisings"



Most people don't know how they are performing, nor how they can improve. Often, managers wait until the annual performance review to provide feedback – by then, there're too many incidents or issues to be addressed in specific, actionable detail.

Once you notice a staff doing something right, offer your one-minute praise:



Share your praises (30 seconds). Share your positive feedback as soon as you can:

- o Tell them specifically what they did right
- o Share how good you feel about their actions, and how they contribute to the goals, team and/or organization.



Pause for a short while. Allow your staff a moment to take in the praise and feel good about their actions.



Affirm your staff (30 seconds). End off by reminding them of your confidence in them, assuring them of your support, and encouraging them to keep up the great work.

This secret is so powerful because **it helps your staff to achieve small wins and successes, which make them feel good about their work, and help the organization to achieve its goals.** Specifically:



Your staff are receiving immediate feedback (rather than waiting for a performance review), and it gives them confidence to do more of what works;



Your specific feedback shows that you're aware of your staff's efforts and sincerely care about their work. This makes them feel appreciated; and



As a manager, you become more consistent in offering timely, positive feedback based on good behaviours (rather than your mood). Over time, your staff will learn the desired behaviours, and can even affirm themselves.

KEY QUOTES

"The more we understand why something works, the more apt we are to use it."

"Help people reach their full potential. Catch them doing something right."

However, for this technique to work, the praise must be deserved and sincerely-delivered.

 **Don't wait for 100%.** Recognize that people can't become perfect overnight, and we should be ready to praise and affirm people when they achieve progress and near-successes.

 **Use smaller-goalposts for newbies.** For new staff, it's vital to set smaller targets that can be achieved more easily, and affirm each small win. It's like encouraging a child who's learning to walk or speak - we don't expect them to walk or speak perfectly from the onset; instead, we're genuinely excited with every small progress that they make. Set people up to win.

Secret #3: "One Minute Re-Direct"



What happens when people make mistakes or do something wrong? Similar to the one-minute praising, the key is to provide feedback as soon as possible, using the "One-Minute Re-Direct".

In the previous version of the book, this was known as the "One Minute Reprimand". However, in today's fast-moving environment, what worked well yesterday may have become redundant today, and people expect more appreciation and fulfilment at work. **The One-Minute Re-Direct is more effective for framing the feedback as a way to help people see different perspectives or solutions.**

Once you're aware of a mistake, quickly check if the goal is clear; if not, start by clarifying it. Then, apply the One-Minute Re-Direct:

 **Address the mistake (30 seconds).** Share your feedback as soon as possible:

- o Verify the facts, and review specifically what didn't go well.
- o Share how you feel about the mis-step, and how it affects the goals, team and/or organization.

 **Pause for a short while.** Allow the message to sink in and give the staff a moment to feel the implications of their mistake.

 **Affirm the staff (30 seconds).** End off by affirming your belief and trust in your staff. Let them know that you still think highly of them as individuals (i.e. they are better than the slip-up), you're confident they'll not repeat the mistake, and you're glad to have them on your team.

KEY QUOTES

"The key in the beginning... is to catch somebody doing something approximately right until they can eventually learn to do it right."

Re-directs need to be delivered with respect and genuine concern for the other person; otherwise they can backfire.



Remember that your goal is to build people up and enable change, so they will do the right things in future. Hence, it's important to end on a positive note. You want people walking away from the interaction thinking how they can do better, rather than feeling angry and indignant.



Separate the action from the person. People who are defensive do not learn from their mistakes; they will simply deny the fault, or blame others. Your goal is not to put people down. **Be hard on the mistake or behaviour, but be gentle on the individual and preserve their self-worth.**



This principle should be applied to the New OMM too – when you make a mistake, admit to it quickly. In fact, you can even ask your staff to point out your mistakes, and learn to laugh at yourself and your faults.



Don't hold on to past mistakes. Once a re-direct is done, move on and look head. However, if someone continues to make the same mistakes, despite several redirects, the New OMM needs to step back and assess the situation objectively (removing emotions from the evaluation). If it's clear that the person is *able* to do the job but *refuses* to do it, then it may warrant a decision to remove him/her from the team.

Putting it Together



A Collaborative Approach

The New OMM approach is about collaborating with, and helping, your team members to deliver great results on their own, so the organization can perform and adapt in a fast-moving environment at all levels. Here are some important principles behind the approach.



Heavier upfront investment. Initially, when people are new and inexperienced, the New OMM must invest more time to guide them – observe their work, highlight what's right, and show them how to make great decisions. **The earlier people can get feedback, the faster they can learn.** Once people function effectively, the New OMM can gradually let go.

KEY QUOTES

"Reaffirming them after you've addressed the mistake focuses on their behaviour without attacking them personally."

"We are not just our behaviour. We are the person managing our behaviour."

"Since speed is a currency of success now, leading with collaboration is far more effective than the old command-and-control system."

"The best minute I spend is the one I invest in people."



Facilitation. The New One-Minute Manager meets his team once a week. Here, the team goes through their accomplishments for the previous week, sets out what must be done next, and how. **The New One-Minute Manager's role is to *facilitate* staff learning and decision-making (not to *instruct* or *direct*).** Team members are responsible for making sound decisions and following up on them. Unlike a top-down approach, this allows people to handle problems effectively as they arise, rather than depend on their manager for direction.



Feeling great about work. If people are an organization's most valuable resource, it's important to dedicate time and resources to developing people (not just improving salaries, technology or hardware). The end-goal is to help people to become great at solving problems, delivering results independently, and feeling good about it – this is when people thrive and produce the best results.



Focus on the core and adapt. Obviously, each of the secrets may not be implemented in exactly 1 minute, and the New OMM must constantly adapt to stay relevant. **The key is to *refocus on key goals using the 80-20 rule, and give timely and specific feedback so you and your team can stay ontrack* to deliver results that matter.**

Why The 3 Secrets Work



Goal setting and performance management in most organizations are like playing bowling with a blindfold on. If you can't see the pins, you don't really know where to aim. If you can't see where your ball lands or which pins you've hit, it's hard to improve or stay motivated. The New OMM approach is akin to removing the blindfold, so everyone can see the pins immediately, and the managers can coach the players to improve.

Obviously, it will be ideal to hire star players, give them their 1-page goal and have them score 100% all by themselves. Unfortunately, such people are rare and expensive to hire. On the other hand, it's also ineffective to hire average people, leave them alone and hope that they'll miraculously deliver outstanding results.

The best way is to hire people with potential, and methodologically coach them to become star players. The One-Minute Goals give people a *clear target* to aim for, and the One-Minute Praisings and

KEY QUOTES

"People who feel good about themselves produce good results."

"It often takes only a minute to refocus on goals and give people important feedback on how they're doing."

"Rather than punish inexperienced people who are still learning, we need to re-direct them."

One-Minute Re-Directs help them with *progressive* course-correction, until they have the knowledge and skills to achieve stellar performance

By jointly setting clear goals, and giving specific feedback in small doses, you enable people to do more of what is right, and stop mistakes as early as possible (rather than accumulate all the negative behaviours and dumping them at the end of the year). When people succeed, feel confident and affirmed in their work, they will push themselves to do even better. **The 3 secrets of the New OMM allow you to concurrently focus on people and results, so both the staff and organization win.**

Remember: people work for themselves not for you as the manager. **Your true goal is to empower people to self-manage *and* feel good about it, so you need not manage them.** That way, you'll free up your own time to plan and improve your own results, enjoy less stress and more time for yourself and your loved ones, and positively impact others to enjoy greater success and fulfilment.

Other Details in the Book to Look out For



This is an extremely easy-to-read book, presented in a short story that anyone can identify with. Although the ideas are simple, they have remained relevant after 35 years, and are practical and easy to apply in our hectic workplace.

If you enjoy the ideas in this summary, do get a copy of the book or get more tips and ideas from <http://newoneminutemanager.com>. Do also share the posts and tips provided on their website.

KEY QUOTES

"Performance review should be an ongoing process, not something you do only once a year."

"Your job is to show people how to manage themselves and enjoy it. You want them to succeed when you're not around."

- Don't seek to beat others; seek to beat yourself. Never be satisfied with your results; continuously push yourself to do even better tomorrow.

Scroll IX: "I will act now."



Big dreams and goals are useless if they're not backed by real action. Your actions may not bring instant results, but without action there'll definitely be no results.



Your actions will determine the value you create. To multiply your value, multiply your actions.



The best way to overcome your fear is to take action in spite of it. Remind yourself repeatedly "I will act now". When you face rejection, take action to knock on the next door immediately. When you feel like procrastinating, take action now instead. When you face a distraction, take action to move away from it right away.

Scroll X: "Pray to God for Guidance"



Regardless of our religious beliefs, all of us instinctively pray for help when we're desperate.



Don't pray for material things or rewards. Instead, pray for guidance on how to achieve your goals.



Scroll X ends with a salesman's prayer. Use it to seek guidance to develop your abilities and tap on opportunities, to stay courageous in face of challenges and your weaknesses, to stay humble despite success, to have the discipline and persistence to keep trying, to develop good habits, be grateful and fulfill your true potential.



Other Details in the Book to Look out For

Mandino has carefully worded the original text in each of the 10 scrolls to help readers to grasp the meaning behind the principles. According to Mandino, the key to success is to read each of the 10 scrolls in sequence, 3 times a day for 30 days each. To download the scrolls and get more details and resources, please visit www.ogmandino.com.

KEY QUOTES

"To surpass the deeds of others is unimportant; to surpass my own deeds is all."

"Only action determines my value in the market place."

"Action is the food and drink which will nourish my success."